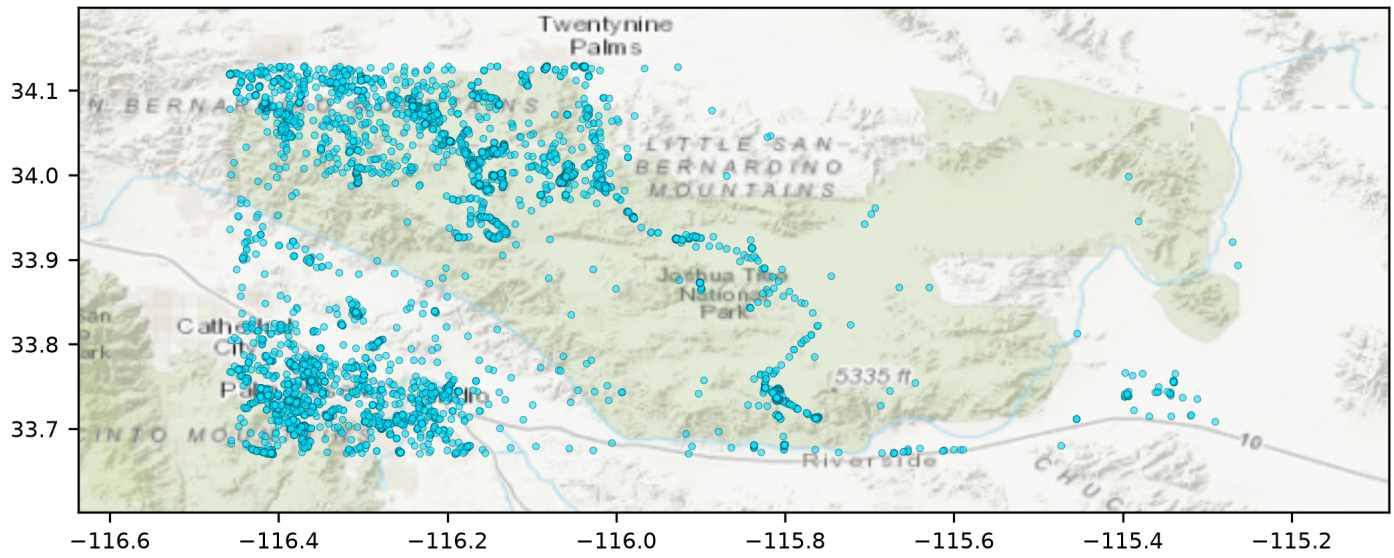
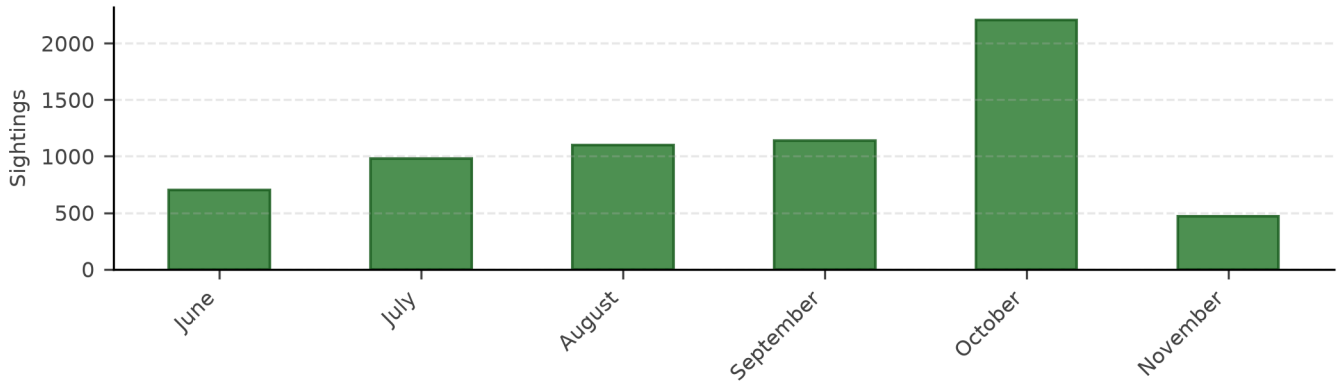
Biodiversity Field Guide: Joshua Tree National Park

Data Gathered via iNaturalist (Most recent 6,600 observations)

Wildlife Sighting Distribution



Monthly Observation Counts



Most Observed Species (Top 35)

Rank	Species (Common Name / Scientific Name)	Sightings	% of Observations
1	Western Joshua Tree (Yucca brevifolia)	206	3.12%
2	Common Side-blotched Lizard (Uta stansburiana)	136	2.06%
3	Desert Spiny Lizard (Sceloporus magister)	113	1.71%
4	Silver Cholla (Cylindropuntia echinocarpa)	110	1.67%
5	Common Raven (Corvus corax)	100	1.52%
6	Branched Pencil Cholla (Cylindropuntia ramosissima)	96	1.45%
7	Creosote Bush (Larrea tridentata)	87	1.32%
8	Mojave Yucca (Yucca schidigera)	82	1.24%
9	Western Whiptail (Aspidoscelis tigris)	81	1.23%
10	California Buckwheat (Eriogonum fasciculatum)	75	1.14%
11	Catclaw Acacia (Senegalia greggii)	69	1.05%
12	Greater Roadrunner (Geococcyx californianus)	68	1.03%
13	Gambel's Quail (Callipepla gambelii)	66	1.0%
14	Long-tailed Brush Lizard (Urosaurus graciosus)	63	0.95%
15	California Barrel Cactus (Ferocactus cylindraceus)	62	0.94%
16	Costa's Hummingbird (Calypte costae)	62	0.94%
17	Muller's oak (Quercus cornelius-mulleri)	61	0.92%
18	California juniper (Juniperus californica)	59	0.89%
19	Mediterranean House Gecko (Hemidactylus turcicus)	57	0.86%
20	Wedgeleaf Goldenbush (Ericameria cuneata)	56	0.85%
21	Queen (Danaus gilippus)	54	0.82%
22	Coyote (Canis latrans)	53	0.8%
23	Mallard (Anas platyrhynchos)	53	0.8%
24	Black-throated Sparrow (Amphispiza bilineata)	52	0.79%
25	Teddybear Cholla (Cylindropuntia bigelovii)	49	0.74%
26	Desert Cottontail (Sylvilagus audubonii)	47	0.71%
27	Zebra-tailed Lizard (Callisaurus draconoides)	47	0.71%
28	jojoba (Simmondsia chinensis)	45	0.68%
29	Armored Stink Beetle (Eleodes armata)	44	0.67%
30	Mourning Dove (Zenaida macroura)	43	0.65%
31	White-tailed Antelope Squirrel (Ammospermophilus leucurus)	42	0.64%
32	Southwestern Speckled Rattlesnake (Crotalus pyrrhus)	40	0.61%
33	California Harvester Ant (Pogonomyrmex californicus)	40	0.61%
34	ocotillo (Fouquieria splendens)	39	0.59%
35	Black-crowned Night Heron (Nycticorax nycticorax)	39	0.59%

Top 20 Dominant Regional Flora (Plants)

#1 Western Joshua Tree
Yucca brevifolia
Sightings: **206**
Peak: **October** (67 obs)

#2 Silver Cholla
Cylindropuntia echinocarpa
Sightings: **110**
Peak: **October** (43 obs)

#3 Branched Pencil Cholla
Cylindropuntia ramosissima
Sightings: **96**
Peak: **October** (41 obs)

#4 Creosote Bush
Larrea tridentata
Sightings: **87**
Peak: **October** (30 obs)

#5 Mojave Yucca
Yucca schidigera
Sightings: **82**
Peak: **October** (26 obs)

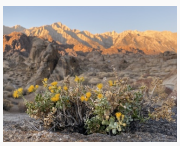
#6 California Buckwheat
Eriogonum fasciculatum
Sightings: **75**
Peak: **October** (28 obs)

#7 Catclaw Acacia
Senegalia greggii
Sightings: **69**
Peak: **October** (23 obs)

#8 California Barrel Cactus
Ferocactus cylindraceus
Sightings: **62**
Peak: **October** (31 obs)

#9 Muller's oak
Quercus cornelius-mulleri
Sightings: **61**
Peak: **October** (28 obs)

#10 California juniper
Juniperus californica
Sightings: **59**
Peak: **October** (28 obs)



#11 Wedgeleaf Goldenbush
Ericameria cuneata
Sightings: **56**
Peak: **October** (43 obs)

#12 Teddybear Cholla
Cylindropuntia bigelovii
Sightings: **49**
Peak: **October** (17 obs)

#13 jojoba
Simmondsia chinensis
Sightings: **45**
Peak: **October** (21 obs)

#14 ocotillo
Fouquieria splendens
Sightings: **39**
Peak: **October** (22 obs)

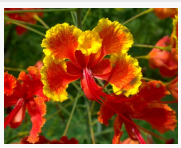
#15 Desert Trumpet
Eriogonum inflatum
Sightings: **37**
Peak: **October** (18 obs)

#16 Green Rabbitbrush
Ericameria teretifolia
Sightings: **34**
Peak: **October** (26 obs)

#17 Beavertail Pricklypear
Opuntia basilaris
Sightings: **33**
Peak: **October** (9 obs)

#18 California fan palm
Washingtonia filifera
Sightings: **33**
Peak: **October** (13 obs)

#19 Pancake Pricklypear
Opuntia chlorotica
Sightings: **31**
Peak: **October** (18 obs)



#20 peacock flower
Caesalpinia pulcherrima
Sightings: **30**
Peak: **September** (12 obs)

Top 20 Dominant Regional Fauna (Animals)

#1 Common Side-blotched Lizard
Uta stansburiana
Sightings: **136**
Peak: **October** (43 obs)

#2 Desert Spiny Lizard
Sceloporus magister
Sightings: **113**
Peak: **July** (38 obs)

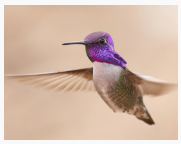
#3 Common Raven
Corvus corax
Sightings: **100**
Peak: **October** (32 obs)

#4 Western Whiptail
Aspidoscelis tigris
Sightings: **81**
Peak: **October** (24 obs)

#5 Greater Roadrunner
Geococcyx californianus
Sightings: **68**
Peak: **August** (16 obs)

#6 Gambel's Quail
Callipepla gambelii
Sightings: **66**
Peak: **August** (22 obs)

#7 Long-tailed Brush Lizard
Urosaurus graciosus
Sightings: **63**
Peak: **August** (38 obs)

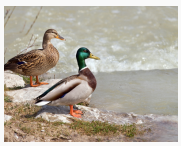


#8 Costa's Hummingbird
Calypte costae
Sightings: **62**
Peak: **October** (26 obs)

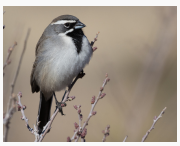
#9 Mediterranean House Gecko
Hemidactylus turcicus
Sightings: **57**
Peak: **August** (24 obs)

#10 Queen
Danaus gilippus
Sightings: **54**
Peak: **October** (18 obs)

#11 Coyote
Canis latrans
Sightings: **53**
Peak: **October** (15 obs)



#12 Mallard
Anas platyrhynchos
Sightings: **53**
Peak: **October** (32 obs)



#13 Black-throated Sparrow
Amphispiza bilineata
Sightings: **52**
Peak: **September** (17 obs)

#14 Desert Cottontail
Sylvilagus audubonii
Sightings: **47**
Peak: **July** (14 obs)

#15 Zebra-tailed Lizard
Callisaurus draconoides
Sightings: **47**
Peak: **September** (19 obs)

#16 Armored Stink Beetle
Eleodes armata
Sightings: **44**
Peak: **October** (31 obs)

#17 Mourning Dove
Zenaida macroura
Sightings: **43**
Peak: **July** (18 obs)

#18 White-tailed Antelope Squirrel
Ammospermophilus leucurus
Sightings: **42**
Peak: **September** (14 obs)

#19 Southwestern Speckled Rattlesnake
Crotalus pyrrhus
Sightings: **40**
Peak: **September** (12 obs)

#20 California Harvester Ant
Pogonomyrmex californicus
Sightings: **40**
Peak: **September** (17 obs)